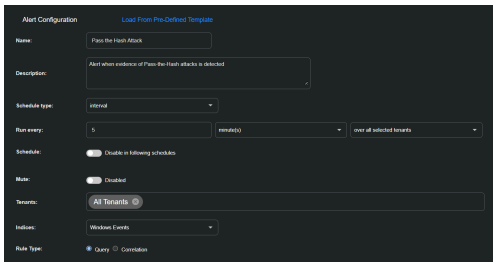
Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

ATH Example: Pass the Hash

Create an Automated Threat Hunting (ATH) playbook that detects potential pass-the-hash attacks in your environment. A pass-the-hash attack allows an adversary to authenticate using hashed credentials without needing the plaintext password. Detecting this activity helps identify lateral movement attempts within your network. This playbook queries authentication events that match known pass-the-hash patterns and alerts you when a match occurs.

Configure the Alert

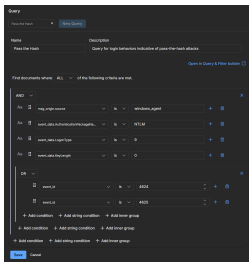
Configure an alert that runs every five minutes against the Windows Events index to identify suspicious logins that may indicate pass-the-hash activity. Running this check frequently ensures timely detection of credential misuse.



1. Navigate to **Automation | Automation** and click the **Create**button to add a playbook.
2. Enter the following in the **Alert Configuration** section:
    - **Name**: **Pass the Hash Attack**
    - **Description**: **Alert when evidence of Pass-the-Hash attacks is detected**
    - **Schedule type**: **interval**
    - **Run every**: **5 minute(s) over all selected tenants**
    - **Schedule**: Toggle off (default setting)
    - **Mute**: Toggle off (default setting)
    - **Tenants**: **All Tenants**
    - **Indices**: **Windows Events**
    - **Rule Type**: **Query**

Build a Query

Build a query that identifies logins using New Technology LAN Manager (NTLM), a legacy Windows authentication protocol. The query focuses on logins that use cached credentials and no session key, which is behavior consistent with common pass-the-hash techniques. The query also includes both successful and failed login attempts to ensure broader visibility into potentially unauthorized access.



1. Select **New Query**.
2. Enter the following:
    - **Query Name**: **Pass the Hash**
    - **Description**: **Query for login behaviors indicative of pass-the-hash attacks**
    - Find documents where **ALL** of the following criteria are met.
    - Select **+ Add condition** and enter **msg_origin.source**, **is**, **windows_agent**.
3. Select **+ Add condition** and enter **event_data.AuthenticationPackageName**, **is**, **NTLM**.
4. Select **+ Add condition** and enter **event_data.LogonType**, **is**, **9**.

    This login type (9) indicates a login using cached credentials.
5. Select **+ Add condition** and enter **event_data.KeyLength**, **is**, **0**.

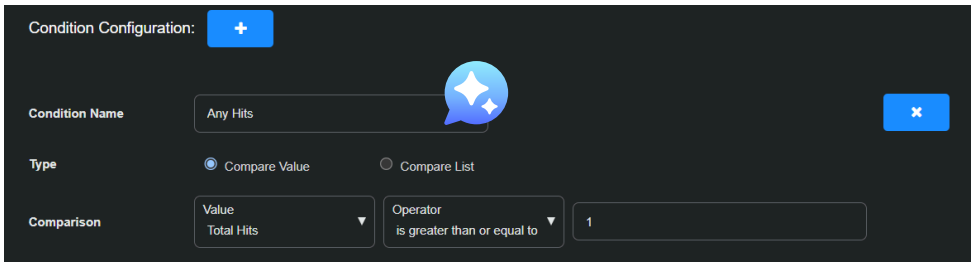
    This (0) indicates that no session key was requested.
6. Select **+ Add Inner Group**.
7. Change the condition type from **AND** to **OR**.
8. Select **+ Add condition** within the inner group and enter **event_id**, **is**, **4624**.

    This indicates a successful login.
9. Still within the inner group, select **+ Add condition** and enter **event_id**, **is**, **4625**.

    This indicates a failed login.
10. Select **Save** to save the query.

Configure a Condition

Define a condition that triggers the playbook actions if at least one matching event is found. This allows the playbook to respond immediately to any signs of pass-the-hash activity.



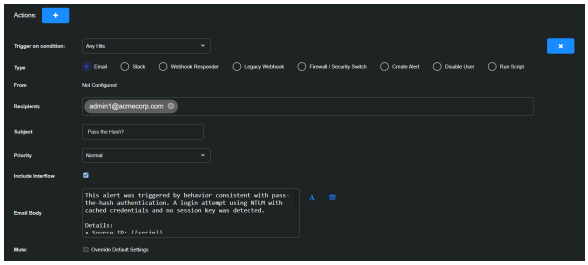
Condition Name: **Any Hits**

Type: **Compare Value**

Comparison: **Total Hits**, **is greater than or equal to**, **1**

Configure an Email Message as the Action

Specify the actions to take when the condition is met. In this example, the playbook sends an email notification that includes relevant details for investigation, including Interflow data to support deeper analysis.



1. Set the **Trigger on condition** to **Any Hits**.
2. Enter the following to set up email messages:
    - **Type**: **Email**
    - **Recipients**: Either type in an email address to use or choose a previously configured recipient from the drop-down list.

      Refer to Adding a Recipient for information on managing recipients globally.
    - **Subject**: **Pass the Hash?**
    - **Priority**: **Normal**
    - **Include Interflow**: (select to attach Interflow records to the email)
    - **Email Body**: Enter the following:

      ```
      This alert was triggered by behavior consistent with pass-the-hash authentication. A login attempt using NTLM with cached credentials and no session key was detected.

      Details:
      ```

        - `Source IP: {{srcip}}`
        - `Username: {{username}}`
        - `Host: {{hostname}}`

    - Logon Type: {{logon_type}}
    - Event Time: {{timestamp}}

  Please review these details in Interflow and investigate whether the activity is authorized or indicative of credential misuse or lateral movement.

- **Mute**: (disable)

 See Configure Actions for details on configuring each type of action.

Save & Run the Playbook

Select **Submit** to save and immediately run the playbook.

The new playbook appears in the Automated Threat Hunting Playbooks list.

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